15

DRESS DESIGNING

15.1 INTRODUCTION

Todays world is a world of fashion. The designs of dresses are changing everyday the world over. India is not far behind. Indian dress are very popular even in western countries. One can see fashionable dresses everywhere - at weddings and marriages, in the market, in fairs, at the university. There is a popular saying which says "wear what others like, eat what you like". It is not only the rich and successful who can wear fashionable clothes. Dress designers today have brought fashion to the masses too. It is easy to design attractive clothes. One needs to know what is dress designing and the process to be followed in designing clothes.

15.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- explain what is dress designing;
- demonstrate how to set different designs.

15.3 MEANING

Dress designing refers to shaping the fabric according to the figure and quality of the cloth by giving an appropriate design.

a) Meaning of dress

Dress refers to the garment or set of garments which attractively cover the human

body from top to bottom.

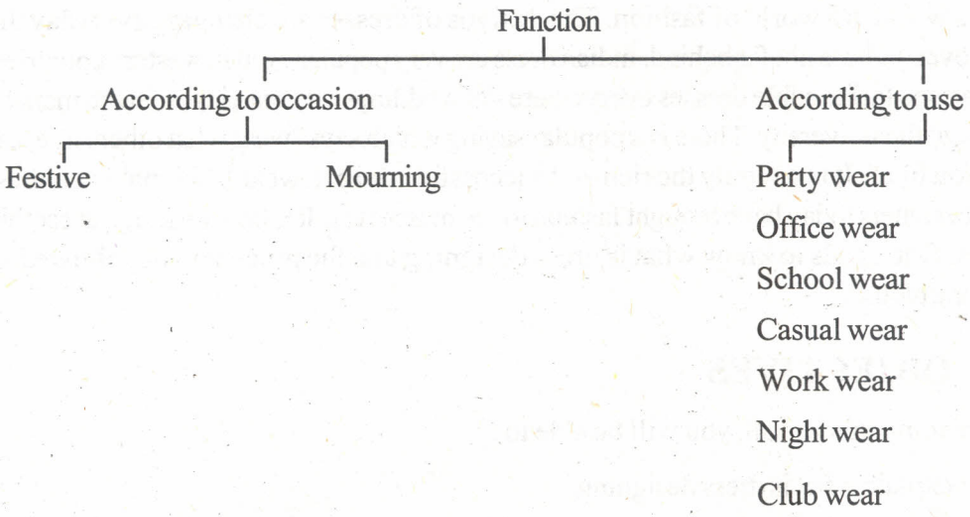
b) Meaning of designing

Designing refers to the creation of a new design of a garment without disturbing the basic foundation lines. This in effect means moulding the basic garment according to customer's preference and in tune with the prevalent fashion while adding your own touch to give it a new look.

Dresses can be made to look attractive by designing. Design can be created to make dresses out of less cloth or by combining small pieces of cloth. Designing makes use of accessories like zari, embroidery, mirrors, metal buttons, lace, sequins etc to give an attractive look.

15.4 RULES OF DESIGNING

The following rules and points should be kept in mind - while designing, it is important to consider the climate and the occasion for which the dress is to be used. The design, to a large extent, depends upon the use of the garment. The following rules must be kept in mind while designing:



1. According to occasion

While designing a dress it is important to consider the occasion for which the dress is to be worn. Different types of dress are worn while celebrating or mourning.

i) Festive occasion

Bright clothes are preferred on festive occasion like wedding or festivals. Dark and bright colours reflect the happy mood of these occasions. Accessories like

zari, sequins, lace, etc. can successfully be used while designing dresses for such occasions.

ii) Mourning

Dresses in plain designs and light colours are suitable for mourning. They reflect the sad mood at these times.

2. Purpose of the dress

While designing a dress we should keep in mind the purpose of the dress, i.e. where is it to be worn, what work will be done when it is worn, etc. Each type of dress has a different purpose, e.g. a uniform is worn in school, formal clothes are worn at work, party clothes are worn at a party. etc. Hence, the purpose of the dress influences the design.

i) Party wear

One can select bright, attractive dresses to wear to a party. The dress can be beautifully designed and in dark colours. One can select dresses fashionably designed with lace, embroidery, ribbons etc. One looks attractive wearing a well designed fashionable dress to party.

ii) Club wear

One must be conscious of the fashion of the dress while going to the club but the dress should also be age appropriate.

iii) Officer wear

Simple, plain dresses are preferable for office wear. Nevertheless, they must look good.

iv) School wear

A uniform is worn at school. When all the school children wear a uniform, it establishes a common identity. It also brings all the children at the same level and prevents inferiority among the children. A uniform is generally made without any design.

v) Picnic wear

Dark, rich coloured clothes in good designs are suitable for picnics.

vi) Work wear

Different types of work requires different types of clothes to be worn. For example,

When dusting or cleaning at home, a duster coat or house coat should be worn; when cooking an apron should be worn. Mechanics need to wear dungarees which have many big pockets to hold their tools.

vii) Night wear

Loose fitting clothes should be worn while sleeping, so that one is comfortable at night. Hence while designing night wear the two factors to be kept in mind are- looseness and comfort.

3. Clothing construction

A design is made on the basis of the body shape. In other words, a design is greatly influenced by the body shape. For example, one can use frills and smocking to give fullness to a dress for a thin child. This will help in masking the thinness of the child. If a child is plump, the dress will have to be designed to make her appear less plum. A dress for a lady with the following measurements - bust - 36", waist 25", hip - 40", will have to be so designed that it looks decent on the body.

Let us now study clothing construction in detail

i) Style emphasis

ii) Treatment of major points

iii) Prominent style points

i) Style emphasis

The basic point to be kept in mind while designing is that the design should emphasise the good features of the wearer and conceal any figure defects. For example, if a person has straight shoulders, then ready made pads can be inserted so that the defect can be canceled.

ii) Treatment of major points

One must prepare a sketch to see what the final design is going to look like and the body structure of the wearer has to be kept in mind while designing. For example, a dress for a person with a thin, long neck can be designed to have a collar or a neck band.

iii) Prominent style point

Every dress has one prominent style point which governs other things. For example, in a gents shirt, the collar is the most prominent feature. A shirt can be made very

attractive by designing a beautiful collar for it. Similarly in a ladies blouse, the darts are the prominent feature. If the darts are not placed correctly, an attractive, well fitting blouse can not be made. Hence, while designing, the prominent style point should be kept in mind.

INTEXT QUESTIONS 15.1

Answer the following in brief.

i) Differentiate between clothes worn on festive occasions and at mourning.

ii) What are the points to keep in mind during clothing construction?

15.5 CONCEPT OF DRESS DESIGNING

The following factors should be considered while designing a dress:

i) Style

The style in which a dress is to be made has to consider many things like the texture and weave of the fabric, the colour, fall, etc. If these things are not kept in mind while setting the design the final product will not look attractive.

ii) Weave

The weave and texture of the fabric influence the design to a great degree. A dress of light material to be worn in summers will be loose and open whereas a dress to be worn in winter will have collar, full selves, etc. Features like smocking or honey combing can not be used on heavy fabrics but tucks, pleats, etc. can easily be used.

iii) Weather

Clothes should ideally be designed according to the weather. Clothes meant to be worn in winters can be made of heavy, thick fabrics. They can have full sleeves, close fitting, heavy designs, frills, etc. Whereas clothes to be worn in summer should be made of light fabrics, with simple designs and in light colours.

iv) Colour

The colour of clothes should complement the figure and complexion of the wearer. This is an important feature to consider otherwise even the best designed dress will not look attractive on the wearer.

v) Trimming material

The trimming material should be used according to the design and it should be used in correct proportions. Too much or too little trimming material will make the dress appear unattractive. Trimming material could be -

a) tailor made trimming material

b) decorative trimming material

vi) Design

The design on a dress should not be too heavy or too light. In both cases, the dress will not be very attractive. Hence, a proportionate amount of design should be used on a dress.

Advantages

1) Fitting

If the above factors are kept in mind while designing a dress, the final product is sure to have a good fitting and will look attractive.

2) Fashion

A dress according to the latest fashion can easily be designed while keeping the factors such as weather, style, figure, etc. in mind.

3) Attractive

A well designed dress will look attractive and be much in demand. It is rightly said-

"God made man

And the tailor makes him attractive".

Dress can be made attractive by designing and can effectively improve the personality of an individual.

15.6 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the meaning of dress designing, its rules and concept and the effect or advantages of designing.

Do and see

Design a dress from the following -

1. Girl who has to work as a teacher
2. For a marriage

15.7 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. What is the meaning of dress designing ? Explain the rules of designing in detail.
2. What type of clothes are suitable for night-wear?

15.8 ANSWERS TO INTEXT QUESTIONS

15.1 (i) Clothes in dark colours bright and attractive are worn on festive occasions. Plain and light coloured clothes are worn at mournings.

(ii) The following points should be considered -

1. Style emphasis
2. Treatment of major points
3. Prominent style points.